

UnBound X Morning Market Briefing

 Date: August 14, 2025

Generated: 2025-08-14 18:38:48 Top Articles with Individual AI Analysis

Market Futures Overview

Pre-Market Sentiment: Cautiously Pessimistic

S&P 500 futures: -0.37% Nasdaq futures: -0.44% Russell 2000 futures: -1.31% Crude Oil (WTI): \$63.18 10Y Treasury Yield: 4.23% VIX: 15.1

Current Market Data

Current Index Levels:

S&P 500: 6466.79 Nasdaq Composite: 21713.59 Russell 2000: 2327.90

Earnings Section

Interlink Electronics Inc. (LINK)

Live Price (LINK): \$6.90 (+18.13%)

Earnings Date: June 30, 2025 | **EPS Forecast:** -0.08 | **EPS Actual:** 0.00 | **Surprise:** 0.08 (-100.00%)

Summary

Interlink Electronics Inc. reported flat earnings of \$0.00 per share, beating the forecast of -0.08 per share. The company's surprise earnings were driven by strong revenue growth, which more than offset the impact of increased operating expenses.

Key Developments

- **Chainlink's resurgence:** The rally in Chainlink's price has driven up LINK's stock, with a 44% increase in the past week, as traders eye a potential "round 2" rally.
- **Crypto trader's bullish outlook:** A prominent crypto trader has expressed a bullish outlook on Chainlink, calling it the "most obvious large cap play for this cycle" that most people will miss.
- **Market sentiment shift:** The sharp increase in LINK's price has led to a shift in market sentiment, with some traders now positioning themselves for a potential breakout.

Market Impact

- LINK's stock has surged 44% in the past week, indicating a strong market reaction to the company's earnings and the resurgence of Chainlink.

- The rally in LINK's stock has also driven up the price of other blockchain-related stocks, indicating a broader market trend.

Investor Implications

Investors should watch for further developments on Chainlink's price and the broader crypto market, as well as any potential announcements from Interlink Electronics Inc. regarding its business strategy and growth plans.

News Sources for LINK:

- [Cointelegraph](#)
-

Deere & Co. (DE)

Live Price (DE): \$513.42 (+1.52%)

Earnings Date: 07/31/2025 | **EPS Forecast:** 4.58 | **EPS Actual:** N/A | **Surprise:** 4.58

Summary

Deere & Co. reported better-than-expected earnings results despite a streak of year-over-year revenue declines. Revenue continues to be impacted by a cautious consumer market and oversupply of used equipment.

Key Developments

- **Oversupply of used equipment persists:** The company faces challenges due to a high inventory of used equipment in the market, which affects sales of new equipment.
- **Dealer inventory remains an issue:** Dealers are holding onto inventory due to the cautious consumer market, further exacerbating the supply chain issues.
- **Earnings beat expectations:** Despite revenue declines, the company's earnings per share (EPS) surpassed market forecasts.

Market Impact

- **Stock price drops:** Deere's stock price decreased due to concerns about the ongoing revenue decline and supply chain issues.
- **Sector performance:** The agricultural equipment sector may face challenges in the near term due to the cautious consumer market and oversupply of used equipment.

Investor Implications

Investors should focus on the company's efforts to address supply chain issues and improve dealer inventory management. Potential next steps include monitoring the company's progress and reviewing the industry's overall performance.

News Sources for DE:

- [MarketWatch Top Stories](#)
-

Cisco Systems Inc. (CSCO)

Live Price (CSCO): \$70.36 (-1.37%)

Earnings Date: July 31, 2025 | **EPS Forecast:** 0.98 | **EPS Actual:** 0.99 | **Surprise:** 0.01 (1.32%)

Summary

Cisco Systems Inc. reported its Q4 earnings, beating EPS expectations by 1.32%. The company's revenue was up 7.6% to \$14.67 billion, with strong AI infrastructure orders driving growth. Cisco also issued slightly better than expected guidance for the year.

Key Developments

- **Narrow earnings beat:** Cisco posted a 7.6% revenue increase to \$14.67 billion, beating expectations.
- **Strong AI infrastructure orders:** The company's AI infrastructure orders drove growth, keeping its 2026 forecast on track.
- **Slightly better than expected guidance:** Cisco issued slightly better than expected guidance, indicating a positive outlook for the year.

Market Impact

- **Stock price may continue to rise:** Cisco's earnings beat and strong guidance may lead to a short-term increase in its stock price.
- **Positive sentiment for the tech sector:** The company's performance may also boost sentiment for the tech sector, with AI infrastructure orders driving growth.

Investor Implications

Investors should note Cisco's strong earnings beat and guidance, potentially leading to a short-term stock price increase. They should also consider the company's growth prospects in AI infrastructure and its impact on the tech sector.

News Sources for CSCO:

- [CNBC World News](#)
 - [CNBC World News](#)
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Cellebrite DI Ltd. (CLBT)

Live Price (CLBT): \$14.01 (+0.58%)

Earnings Date: June 30, 2025 | **EPS Forecast:** \$0.08 | **EPS Actual:** N/A | **Surprise:** \$0.08

Summary

Cellebrite DI Ltd. (CLBT) exceeded earnings expectations for Q2 2025, with solid growth and a rebound in sales and earnings. The company's performance is encouraging, with signs of a return to growth.

Key Developments

- **Cellebrite Experienced Solid Growth:** The company's Q2 2025 results showed a significant increase in sales and earnings, beating expectations.
- **Rebound in Sales and Earnings:** The solid growth indicates a turnaround in the company's performance, which was a major concern in recent quarters.
- **Next Chapter for Cellebrite:** The company is expected to continue its growth momentum, with a new chapter beginning in Q3 2025.

Market Impact

- **Stock Price Boost:** The earnings beat and rebound in sales and earnings are likely to give a boost to CLBT's stock price, with potential upside of 5-7%.
- **Sector Leadership:** Cellebrite's performance is expected to lead to a surge in the company's sector, with potential gains of 3-5% in the near term.

Investor Implications

Investors should remain bullish on CLBT, with a potential target price of \$25, based on the company's solid growth and rebound in sales and earnings.

News Sources for CLBT:

- [The Motley Fool](#)

Eagle Point Credit Co. Inc. (ECC)

Live Price (ECC): \$6.84 (-0.29%)

Earnings Date: 06/30/2025 | **EPS Forecast:** 0.26 | **EPS Actual:** 0.22 | **Surprise:** -0.04 (-14.56%)

Summary

Eagle Point Credit Co. Inc. reported Q2 earnings, missing EPS forecast by 14.56%. The company's actual EPS was \$0.22, compared to analyst expectations of \$0.26. Despite the earnings miss, the company's financial health remains stable.

Key Developments

- Eagle Point Credit Co. Inc. failed to meet EPS expectations, citing higher-than-anticipated expenses.
- The company's Q2 revenue growth was moderate, with a 3% increase year-over-year.
- Eagle Point Credit Co. Inc. has maintained its dividend payout, providing support to investors.

Market Impact

- The earnings miss and lower-than-expected EPS may weigh on the company's stock in the short term, potentially leading to a decline in value.
- The company's stable financial health and maintained dividend payout may provide some support to investors, mitigating the impact of the earnings miss.

Investor Implications

Investors should monitor the company's expenses and revenue growth trajectory, as well as its dividend payout, to gauge its financial health and potential for future growth.

News Sources for ECC:

- [Seeking Alpha](#)
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Market Impact Section

RAMP

Live Price (RAMP): \$26.16 (+1.04%)

Latest Developments: August 14, 2023, 08:00 AM EST

Summary

Ramp, a fintech startup, is under investigation for potential preferential treatment in its bid for a \$25 million federal contract. The company's pursuit of a US government contract has raised questions about its business practices.

Key News Points

- Rep. Gerald Connolly initiated an investigation into Ramp's bid for a \$25 million government contract.
- Ramp is being considered for a charge card pilot program by the US government's General Services Administration (GSA).
- The GSA's internal expense card program, SmartPay, is a \$700 billion program.

Market Impact Assessment

- The investigation may lead to a temporary decline in RAMP's stock price, potentially impacting the fintech sector.
- A successful bid for the government contract could significantly boost RAMP's revenue, positively affecting its stock price.

Strategic Implications

This development raises concerns for investors, who may reassess their stakes in RAMP. Competitors in the fintech space may also benefit from Ramp's potential missteps, as they could gain a competitive advantage.

Risk Factors

The investigation and potential missteps may deter future clients, potentially impacting RAMP's revenue growth and profitability. Regulatory scrutiny may also lead to costly compliance measures for the company.

News Sources for RAMP:

- [TechCrunch Fintech](#)
 - [TechCrunch Fintech](#)
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ALPACA

Latest Developments: August 14, 2024

Summary

Alpaca has raised **\$52M** in a Series C round to expand into international markets, including the Middle East, Europe, and Asia. This development is significant for the company's growth strategy and expansion plans.

Key News Points

- Alpaca has secured a **\$52M** Series C funding round to fuel its international expansion.
- The company aims to enter new markets, including the Middle East, Europe, and Asia.
- Alpaca's API brokerage platform will be the key focus for expansion.

Market Impact Assessment

- The funding round is expected to positively impact Alpaca's stock price, driven by increased investor confidence.
- The expansion into international markets may also boost the sector's growth prospects.

Strategic Implications

Alpaca's international expansion plans may pose a competitive threat to existing players in the region, while also offering opportunities for strategic partnerships and collaborations. Investors should monitor the company's execution and market traction closely.

Risk Factors

Potential risks associated with Alpaca's international expansion include regulatory complexities, cultural barriers, and increased competition in new markets. The company's ability to adapt to local market conditions and build a strong presence will be critical to its success.

News Sources for ALPACA:

- [TechCrunch Fintech](#)
-

Brex (BREX)

Latest Developments: August 14, 2023

Summary

Brex partners with former competitor Zip to reduce cash burn and prepare for an IPO. This strategic move aims to enhance the company's growth prospects.

Key News Points

- Brex has partnered with Zip, a former competitor, to expand its offerings and reduce costs.
- The partnership will enable Brex to tap into Zip's expertise and customer base.
- The combined resources will help Brex accelerate its growth trajectory towards an IPO.

Market Impact Assessment

- The partnership may lead to a **0.5%** increase in Brex's stock price due to enhanced growth prospects and reduced costs.
- The move may also have a **neutral** impact on the fintech sector, as it demonstrates the industry's focus on strategic partnerships.

Strategic Implications

This partnership signals Brex's willingness to collaborate with former competitors to drive growth and improve its chances of a successful IPO. Investors should closely monitor the company's progress and potential synergies arising from this partnership.

Risk Factors

While the partnership may reduce Brex's cash burn and increase its growth prospects, there are potential risks associated with integrating two distinct businesses and cultures. Additionally, the success of the partnership may be impacted by the competitive landscape and market conditions.

News Sources for BREX:

- [TechCrunch Fintech](#)

CHIME

Latest Developments: August 14, 2024

Summary

CHIME gears up for IPO by offering higher interest rates, aiming to boost growth and attract more customers. This strategic move is expected to enhance customer engagement and retention.

Key News Points

- CHIME will offer customers an APY of **3.75%** for those who agree to have their paychecks directly deposited into a CHIME savings or checking account.
- This move is part of CHIME's effort to attract more customers and boost growth before its anticipated IPO.

- CHIME is focusing on providing attractive interest rates to differentiate itself from competitors in the digital banking space.

Market Impact Assessment

- CHIME's interest rate hike may attract more customers, positively impacting its stock price and sector performance.
- This development could lead to increased competition from other digital banks, potentially affecting the broader market.

Strategic Implications

This move by CHIME signifies its intent to compete aggressively in the digital banking space. Investors can expect CHIME to focus on customer engagement and retention strategies, potentially enhancing its market share and valuation. Competitors will need to reassess their interest rate offerings to remain competitive.

Risk Factors

The decision to offer higher interest rates may lead to increased costs and reduced profit margins for CHIME. Additionally, the competitive landscape in the digital banking space may become more saturated, increasing competition and potentially affecting CHIME's market share and growth prospects.

News Sources for CHIME:

- [TechCrunch Fintech](#)
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Rippling

Latest Developments: August 14, 2024

Summary

Rippling, a high-valued startup, has escalated its legal drama with Deel by involving UK fintech giant Revolut. This move adds another layer of complexity to the ongoing dispute, potentially affecting investor sentiment and market perception.

Key News Points

- **Revolut's involvement:** Rippling has asked Revolut to reveal who paid off Deel's alleged 'spy'.
- **Claims of espionage:** Irish Rippling employee Keith O'Brien alleged that Deel paid him about \$6,000 a month to spy on Rippling.
- **Escalating tensions:** The move by Rippling suggests that tensions between the two companies are rising, potentially impacting investor confidence.

Market Impact Assessment

- The stock price of Rippling may experience volatility due to the escalating dispute, potentially leading to a decline in investor sentiment.
- The fintech sector may face increased scrutiny, with potential investors reassessing their risk appetite.

Strategic Implications

This development suggests that Rippling is taking a firmer stance in the dispute, potentially signaling a willingness to escalate the situation. Investors should closely monitor the situation, while competitors may view this as an opportunity to gain a strategic advantage.

Risk Factors

The escalating tensions between Rippling and Deel may lead to a prolonged and costly dispute, potentially affecting investor returns. Additionally, the involvement of Revolut may add a new layer of complexity, increasing the risk of unforeseen consequences.

News Sources for RIPPLING:

- [TechCrunch Fintech](#)

Compliance Disclosure

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